

Palmetto Coordinated System of Care Waiver Information Sheet

South Carolina Department of Health and Human Services

The state of South Carolina developed the Palmetto Coordinated System of Care (PCSC) for South Carolina's youth with significant behavioral health challenges or co-occurring conditions who are in, in or at imminent risk of, out-of-home placement. PCSC is an evidence-based approach that is part of a national movement to develop family-driven and youth-guided care and keep youth at home, in school, and out of the child welfare and juvenile justice systems. The approved §1915(b)(4) and §1915(c) federal waivers allow the South Carolina Department of Health and Human Services (SCDHHS) to collaborate with the SC Continuum of Care (COC) to support the PCSC's goal for youth and families to receive services, when needed, that are designed to help participants achieve safe, healthy, and functional lives as successful, responsible, and productive citizens.

PCSC Waiver Participation

To participate in the PCSC Waiver, a person must:

- ✓ Be diagnosed with a primary behavioral health diagnosis or co-occurring condition;
- ✓ Be eligible to receive Medicaid or already qualify for Medicaid;
- ✓ Require the degree of care that would be provided in an institutional setting; therefore, meet hospital Level of Care criteria;
- ✓ Be given the option of receiving services in his/her home and community or in an institution and choose to receive services in his/her home and community;
- ✓ Have needs that can be met by the PCSC waiver;
- ✓ Be allocated a waiver slot; and,
- ✓ Be informed of the alternatives covered by the PCSC waiver, elect to receive PCSC waiver services and choose among qualified providers.

Applying for PCSC Waiver Services

To apply for PCSC waiver services, a person should:

- ✓ Contact the COC in your area at <http://coc.sc.gov/contact.html>.
- ✓ Inform your local COC representative that you wish to apply for the PCSC waiver. They will work with you to gather the information needed to complete the application.
 - You will receive a written response from COC regarding your PCSC waiver application.

PCSC Waiver Termination

PCSC waiver enrollment is terminated when the participant:

- ✓ Is admitted for institutional care*;
- ✓ No longer meets hospital level of care;
- ✓ Voluntarily withdraws or no longer wishes to receive services funded by the PCSC waiver;
- ✓ Does not receive a PCSC waiver service for 30 consecutive days*; or,
- ✓ Moves out-of-state.

*some exclusions apply.

Your Person-Centered Annual Plan

An annual plan of services and supports **must** be completed within 365 days of the previous plan. If your new plan is not completed by the 364th day, Medicaid cannot pay for your services that were provided. Please work with your High Fidelity Wraparound Facilitator to make sure that your plan is completed at least once every year.

PCSC Waiver Services

PCSC waiver services must be supported by a specific assessed need and justified in the person-centered plan. The services under this waiver are limited to additional services not otherwise covered under the state plan, including Early and Periodic Screening, Diagnosis and Treatment (EPSDT), but consistent with waiver objectives of avoiding institutionalization. The following services are available through the PCSC waiver:

- **High-Fidelity Wraparound:** An evidence-based model which includes intensive service coordination to provide home and community-based supports and services to youth with mental illness who would otherwise be served in inpatient general and psychiatric hospitals. Families and youth are offered the choice of behavioral health services and supports to permit the youth to remain in, or return to, the least restrictive environment, preferably their homes. To be eligible, a potential waiver youth must meet the inpatient level of care and meet all Medicaid financial and COC requirements.
- **Respite:** A face-to-face service that is provided on a short-term, planned or emergency basis, and offers relief to a beneficiary's unpaid or principal caregiver who is unavailable to provide support to the youth. Respite may be provided in an emergency to prevent hospitalization. Respite can be no longer than one week per episode, and not more than 21 days per year. Respite stays of greater than 72 hours require prior authorization. Youth requiring crisis respite for longer periods may be evaluated on an individual basis.
- **Individual Directed Goods and Services:** Services, equipment or supplies not otherwise provided through this waiver or through the Medicaid state plan that address an identified need in the person-centered plan (including improving and maintaining the participant's opportunities for full membership in the community) and meet the following requirements: the item or service would decrease the need for other Medicaid services; AND/OR promote inclusion in the community; AND/OR increase the participant's safety in the home environment; AND the participant does not have the funds to purchase the item or service or the item or service is not available through another source. Experimental or prohibited treatments are excluded. Individual Directed Goods and Services must be documented in the person-centered plan. There is a lifetime cap of \$2,000.00 for each participant.